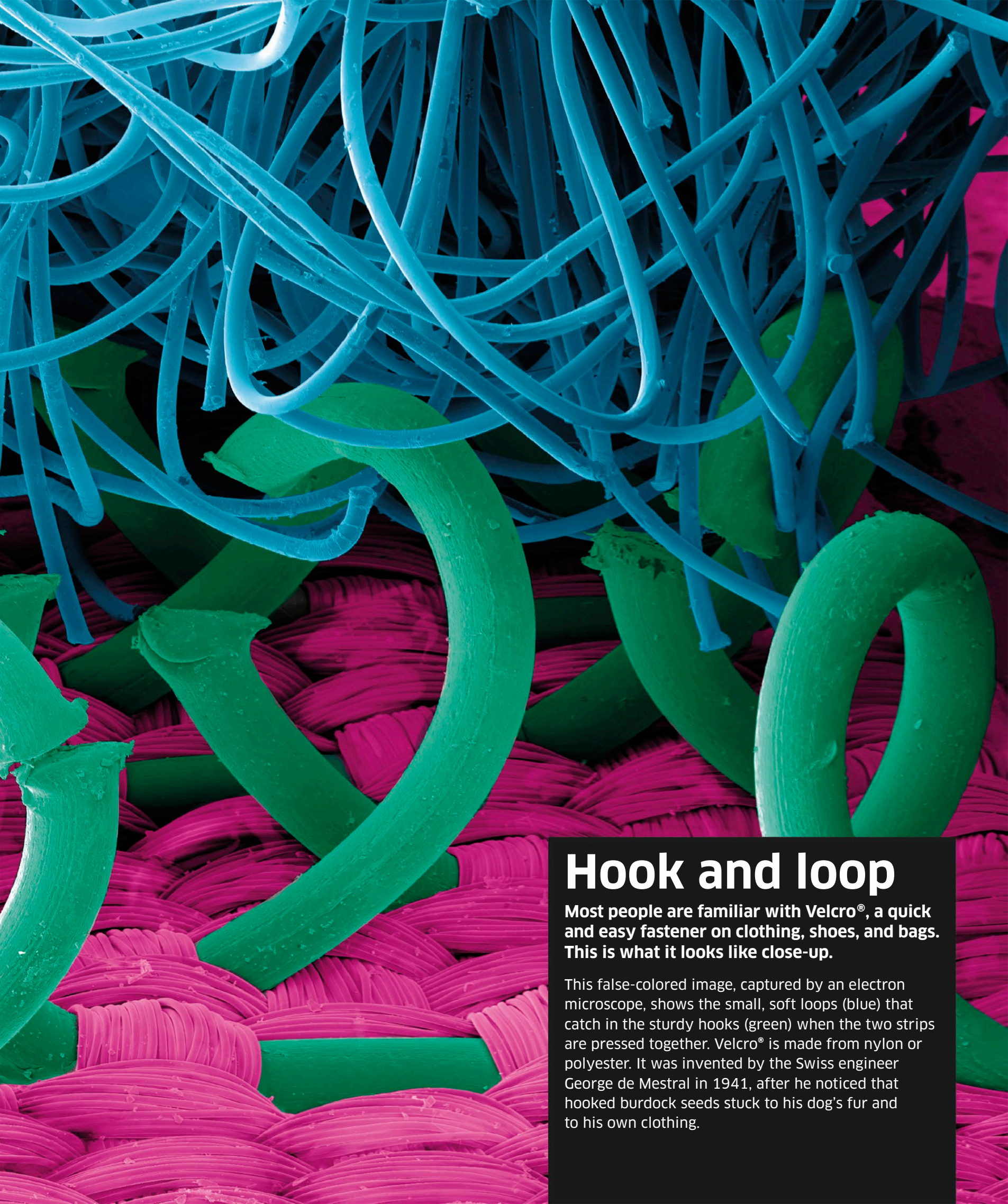




Hook and loop

Most people are familiar with Velcro®, a quick and easy fastener on clothing, shoes, and bags. This is what it looks like close-up.

This false-colored image, captured by an electron microscope, shows the small, soft loops (blue) that catch in the sturdy hooks (green) when the two strips are pressed together. Velcro® is made from nylon or polyester. It was invented by the Swiss engineer George de Mestral in 1941, after he noticed that hooked burdock seeds stuck to his dog's fur and to his own clothing.